

MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

High School Foundations | Unit 5

Suffix -ary



Today I am learning that the suffix -ary often forms words meaning relating to, connected with, or characterised by.

1 Learn the Meaning

The suffix -ary often forms adjectives meaning relating to, connected with, or characterised by. It is common in academic and technical vocabulary. Not every word ending in -ary contains this suffix, so look for a meaningful base or related word.

planetary
relating to planets

dietary
relating to diet

budgetary
relating to a budget

momentary
lasting for a moment

2 Build the Word

Add -ary to the base or related word. Build the new word, then write a short meaning clue.

Base / related	Add	New word	Meaning clue
planet	-ary		
diet	-ary		
budget	-ary		
moment	-ary		
document	-ary		

3 Read and Notice

During a media studies project, Ava's group created a documentary about a temporary marine sanctuary. Their primary goal was to explain how changing dietary conditions affect animals living in coastal habitats. They compared contemporary scientific reports with supplementary interviews from volunteers and local researchers.

The group quickly discovered that the project involved more than filming. Budgetary limits meant they could not travel to every location, so they used documentary footage provided by a university. A veterinary researcher explained how dietary changes can have momentary effects on behaviour as well as longer-term consequences. Another expert described planetary climate patterns that influence ocean temperatures across wide regions.

Before editing the final film, the students made a glossary of unfamiliar -ary words. They noticed that some, such as dietary and budgetary, could be linked clearly to a base word, while others required a related word or more careful investigation. This helped them see that recognising a familiar ending is only the beginning of morphological analysis.



Highlight the -ary words. Underline a base or related word clue when you can, then decide whether -ary is functioning as a suffix.

4 Word Detective

Choose one -ary word from the passage and investigate its structure, related words and meaning.

a

Write an -ary word from the passage.

b

What base or related word can you identify?

c

What does the whole word mean in context?

d

Is -ary functioning as a suffix here? Explain.

5 Sort the Words

Sort the words by whether -ary is a suffix or simply part of the word ending.

planetary

dietary

budgetary

momentary

library

canary

diary

salary

Has suffix -ary

Letters -ary only

6 Use It in Writing



Complete the sentence starters.

a

A budgetary decision is one that

b

Use one -ary word in a sentence and explain its base or related word.



Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Recognises -ary in academic words
- ☐ Identifies a base or related word
- ☐ Distinguishes a suffix from a letter ending
- ☐ Uses derived words accurately in context



Capture idea:

Find an -ary word in a book, article or website. Record the word, identify a base or related word if possible, and explain whether -ary is acting as a suffix.